Returns & Refund Policy

Northstar Retail Ltd

Training document for the Weeks 1-9 automation capstone.
This policy is fictional and exists only for workflow/RAG practice.

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1. Standard Returns

Return window

Customers may request a standard return within 30 calendar days of the delivery date. The item must have been delivered before a standard return can be completed.

Condition of returned goods

Items should be returned unused and in substantially the same condition in which they were received. Original retail packaging should be included where reasonably possible.

Proof of purchase

The order number or another valid proof of purchase is required before a standard return can be processed.

2. Refund Processing

Refund method

Approved refunds are returned to the original payment method unless a different method is required by law.

Processing time

After Northstar Retail receives and approves the returned item, the refund is normally initiated within 5 to 7 business days. Banks and card providers may take additional time to display the credit.

Partial refunds

A partial refund may be considered where an item is returned with missing accessories, avoidable damage, or material signs of use. Partial-refund decisions require human review.

3. Damaged or Faulty Items

Reporting damage

Customers should report visible delivery damage within 7 calendar days of delivery where reasonably possible. They should include the order number and a description of the problem.

Evidence

Customer Support may request photographs or other evidence before deciding the next action.

Routing

Damaged or faulty item cases are treated as high priority and must be reviewed by a member of Customer Support. The automated system must not make a final damaged-item compensation decision.

4. International Returns

Eligibility

International orders may be returned under the same 30-calendar-day standard return window unless local law provides additional rights.

Return postage

For a change-of-mind international return, the customer is normally responsible for return postage and any non-refundable customs or carrier charges.

Faulty international orders

Where an international item is confirmed faulty or was supplied incorrectly, Northstar Retail may provide a prepaid return method or reimburse reasonable return postage after review.

5. Non-returnable Items

Personalised goods

Items made or personalised specifically for the customer are not normally eligible for a change-of-mind return.

Hygiene-sensitive goods

Sealed hygiene-sensitive goods are not normally returnable after the seal has been broken, unless the item is faulty.

Gift cards

Gift cards are not refundable for change of mind, except where required by law.

6. Delivery Charges

Standard delivery charge

The original standard delivery charge may be refunded when the entire order is returned and the customer has a legal or policy entitlement to that refund.

Premium delivery

Any additional amount paid solely for premium, express, timed, or upgraded delivery is not normally refunded for a change-of-mind return.

7. Exchanges

Availability

Direct exchanges are not guaranteed. Where an exchange cannot be processed, the customer may be asked to return the original item and place a new order.

Price differences

Any price difference on a replacement order is handled as part of the new transaction.

8. Escalation and Human Review

Unclear cases

Cases where the available order information conflicts with the customer's statement, where required evidence is missing, or where the policy does not clearly answer the question must be sent for human review.

Policy gaps

The automated assistant must not invent policy. If the policy does not contain enough information to answer a customer's question, it should state that the information could not be found and route the case for human review.

Sensitive or exceptional decisions

Legal threats, suspected fraud, chargeback disputes, unusually high-value compensation requests, and exceptions to this policy require human review.

Suggested RAG checks: international return postage; refund processing time; premium delivery charge; personalised goods; direct exchanges. A question about pension contributions is intentionally not answered by this policy.